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Teaching Statement

My teaching is guided by a simple principle: students learn best when they connect substantive political questions to concrete analytical practice. Whether I teach global governance, international institutions, or data analysis, I aim to create a classroom in which students not only acquire knowledge, but also learn how to ask meaningful questions, evaluate evidence, and communicate arguments clearly. I view teaching as both intellectual training and mentorship, and I work to help students from varied backgrounds develop confidence in their analytical abilities. More broadly, I want students to think and act like social scientists by building strong foundations in political inquiry, scientific reading and writing, and oral presentation skills.

My role as a teacher does not begin, nor end, at the front of a classroom. I see teaching as extending across advising meetings, office hours, research guidance, reading groups, and informal conversations that help students make sense of their academic and professional trajectories. Before beginning my Ph.D., I taught political science, social studies, and English in both urban and rural junior and senior high schools in Taiwan. These experiences taught me how to adapt my pedagogy to students with different levels of preparation and from different social backgrounds. At Indiana University, I have continued this commitment through teaching, mentoring, and service. In my courses, I have guided students in developing original research projects and provided recommendation letters, advising, and academic support beyond the classroom. As a graduate student leader, including service on the Department of Political Science's Diversity and Inclusion Committee, I have also worked to strengthen inclusive departmental practices and to foster environments in which students feel acknowledged, supported, and able to succeed.

A central feature of my teaching philosophy is the integration of substantive inquiry with hands-on learning. As Instructor of Record for *Politics of Global Governance* [Syllabus], I designed the course around major debates on institutional design, international cooperation, and global problem-solving. Rather than treating theory as abstract, I encouraged students to use it as a tool for understanding real-world cases and policy challenges. Students moved through a scaffolded learning process: they completed short quizzes to reinforce key concepts, discussed policy paper ideas with me before drafting, and applied theoretical frameworks to analyze real-world op-eds and policy problems. Their final projects covered topics ranging from global health crises and environmental governance to food security, gender equity, and geopolitical rivalry. My goal was to help students move beyond memorization and toward analytical reasoning about how institutions function in practice.

This same philosophy guides my methods teaching. As Instructor of Record for *Data Fluency* [Syllabus], I taught an introductory course covering research design, data-driven reasoning, and tools such as Excel, `R`, and Tableau. I emphasized analytical literacy, reproducible research, data storytelling, and research communication, helping students move beyond technical execution to explain clearly why their findings mattered. Students completed project-based assignments involving data wrangling, visualization, introductory machine learning, network analysis, and short presentations designed for broader audiences. Their final projects addressed topics such as AI use, athlete injury and performance, coffee and health, mental health and lifestyle, the NBA, self-tracked gym behavior, social media advertising and engagement, student academic stress, and global sports finance. To support this work, I carefully scaffolded assignments and encouraged students to structure presentations around a clear central takeaway supported by evidence. In this role, I also gained leadership experience by supervising and coordinating with three graduate associate instructors.

Because I value inclusive and active learning, I work to create multiple pathways for participation. In class, I facilitate discussion through low-stakes questions, group discussion, and completion-based activities that encourage students to contribute without anxiety about getting the "right answer" immediately. I see purposeful feedback, both inside and outside the classroom, as essential to student improvement. I want students to understand that learning often happens through revision, reflection, and engagement with mistakes. For this reason, I often provide opportunities for students to revisit and improve their work, while also making space for students who may be less comfortable speaking in class to participate through written or small-group formats. Inclusive teaching, for me, requires both empathy and flexibility.

Beyond the classroom, I am committed to mentoring students as emerging scholars and professionals. Through the IU Center of Excellence for Women & Technology, I was invited to teach a crash course in `R`, introducing students to data import, manipulation, analysis, and visualization through hands-on exercises. In that setting, I also showed students how generative AI tools can support learning through code generation, troubleshooting, and discovering new analytical methods. More generally, I have mentored students on writing professional emails, developing research questions, navigating transfer applications, and strengthening academic materials, and I have written recommendation letters in support of their educational goals. I believe successful mentorship depends on building meaningful connections with students and helping them see themselves as capable participants in academic and professional communities.

Student feedback has reinforced the effectiveness of this approach. In *Data Fluency* [Evaluation], over 95% of students indicated that they would recommend the course and instructor. Qualitative comments frequently highlighted my approachability, clarity, and ability to connect course material to real-world examples. Feedback from *Politics of Global Governance* [Evaluation] similarly emphasized accessibility, flexibility, and supportive engagement. I take these evaluations seriously not simply as endorsements, but as evidence that careful course design, responsiveness, and genuine investment in students can improve learning outcomes.

My broader teaching experience has prepared me to contribute to interdisciplinary programs in political science, international affairs, public policy, and computational social science. In addition to serving as Instructor of Record for *Politics of Global Governance* and *Data Fluency*, I have guest lectured and worked as an Associate Instructor for seven semesters in courses such as *International Organization*, *Analyzing Politics*, and *Introduction to Informatics*. These experiences have allowed me to teach students with different academic interests, professional goals, and levels of methodological preparation. My teaching is also shaped by prior professional experience in international policy practice. Before beginning my Ph.D., I worked as the full-time coordinator for Taiwan's Bureau of Small and Medium Enterprise to APEC and later as an Assistant Research Fellow at the Taiwan Institute of Economic Research, where I contributed to policy initiatives, capacity-building projects, and applied research related to regional governance and economic cooperation. This background helps me show students that political science is not only an academic discipline, but also a practical way of understanding and engaging real policy problems.

I am prepared and excited to teach a wide range of undergraduate- and graduate-level courses, including:

Substantive Courses

International Relations & IPE
International Relations
International Political Economy
International Organization
Global Governance
International Conflict
Strategic Studies
Global Political Economy
War and Armed Conflict

Regional Studies
East Asian Politics
International Relations in East Asia
Politics of Southeast Asia
U.S.-China-Taiwan Relations
U.S. Foreign and Security Policy
Asia-Pacific International Relations

Comparative & American Politics
Comparative Politics
American Government
American Institutions and Ideas

Methods Courses

Research Methods in Political Science
Research Design in International Relations
`R` for Political Data Analysis
Data Science for Political Inquiry
Social Network Analysis
AI-Assisted Research Design
Computational Social Science
Quantitative Methods for International Relations

Professional Courses

Policy Analysis
Careers in Political Science

Specialized Seminars

Human Security in Global Context
Politics of the Global South
Climate Change & Global Politics
Migration & International Politics

I would also be especially enthusiastic about mentoring student research and capstone projects that combine substantive political questions with evidence-based analysis and original research design. My own experience in political science, methods instruction, and policy-oriented research allows me to support students not only in formulating research questions, but also in communicating their findings clearly to academic, policy, and public audiences.

In sum, my teaching philosophy emphasizes analytical clarity, research-driven learning, inclusive engagement, and sustained mentorship. I seek to equip students with the conceptual and methodological tools needed for independent research, policy analysis, and informed public engagement. Whether students go on to graduate school, policy work, or other professional paths, I want them to leave my courses with stronger analytical skills, greater intellectual confidence, and a deeper sense of how political science can help them understand and shape the world around them.

Appendix: Supplementary Teaching Materials

Teaching Evaluations

Data Fluency (Fall 2025)	• Course rating: **4.1/5**; department average: 4.1/5 • Instructor rating: **4.2/5**; department average: 4.3/5 • Over 95% would recommend the course and instructor • [Full Report] and [Syllabus]
Politics of Global Governance (Summer 2023)	• Course rating: **5/5**; department average: 4.0/5 • Instructor rating: **5/5**; department average: 3.9/5 • Strongest evaluations; interpret with caution due to limited response rate • Listed in the evaluation system as *Politics in the Developing World* • [Full Report] and [Syllabus]

Selected Student Testimonials

- "He released countless study resources to help us be successful on the exam. Additionally, he is helpful in extending deadlines and meeting the students where they need. I was fortunate to have such a caring professor."
- "I liked how much he related it to the real world and how nice he was to everyone."
- "The instructor genuinely cared about whether we understood the content. They broke things down in a simple way and always connected lessons to real-life examples, which made the material more interesting."
- "Mr. Wang is nothing short of an exceptional empathetic person here to help."
- "The instructor is so extremely approachable and kind. He has been more than generous in accommodating summer schedules. I also like that he tells us when he is also learning about emerging research in this field."
- "I wanted to have the class and discussions before the readings and papers. I would prefer a different format for numbering the modules, readings and quizzes. That is all. I have only good things to say about the instructor, and I believe that our university is fortunate to have him in multiple roles."

Professional Pedagogical Development

- **Political Science and Professional Development**, Indiana University. Graduate coursework on lecturing, leading discussion, designing assignments, developing course materials, and evaluating student learning.
- **Center for the Integration of Research, Teaching, and Learning (CIRTL) Network — Associate Level.** Formal pedagogical training in evidence-based and inclusive teaching.
- **Instructor of Record Meeting Group**, led by Akesha Horton, Director of Curriculum and Instruction, Indiana University Luddy School of Informatics, Computing, and Engineering.